

Shady Alzayat

VP of Engineering / Hands-On Full-Stack Builder

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VP of Engineering, 15+ years leading organizations of up to 40+ engineers while staying hands-on with architecture, product tradeoffs, and production code. The right fit for a platform that has outgrown its first architecture and the org its first process: enterprise ordering, payments, and healthcare products where compliance, uptime, and delivery pace must hold at once. Recent stack: React, TypeScript, Node.js, AWS Serverless, CI/CD, agent-assisted development workflows.

EXPERIENCE

Appetier.com, Founding Engineer San Francisco · Mar 2025 - Present

- Build the Appetier restaurant platform end-to-end (product, React frontend, Node.js backend, AWS infrastructure), using AI-assisted workflows (Claude Code, Codex, Cursor) to compress iteration cycles.
- Designed agent-based delivery pipelines with OpenSpec, MCP, and automated testing, plus harness-agnostic developer environments, keeping architecture, data contracts, and quality gates under strict governance.

Tillster, VP of Software Engineering Los Angeles · Jul 2021 - Mar 2025

- Grew the organization to **40 engineers** across 6 teams and 6 engineering managers at **95% retention** and **98% delivery predictability**, hiring the management layer and owning levels, career ladder, and performance practice on a **\$9M budget** across US and offshore teams.
- Scaled the platform from **8 to 29 enterprise QSR brands** with an engineering flat at ~40, a **3.6x gain in capacity per engineer**, via shared services, configuration over customization, and automated brand onboarding.
- Designed event-driven backend services and dispatch/fleet apps for ordering, routing, and driver utilization, supporting **2M daily orders at 99.99% uptime** through peak traffic.
- Architected card payments infrastructure and led **PCI DSS** work across encryption, tokenization, chargebacks, risk controls, and audit readiness.
- Cut deployment rollout time 50% via CI/CD, QA automation, feature flags, and rollback practices; improved frontend performance 30% through React and TypeScript profiling and caching.
- Launched AI support agents integrated with POS and order-status systems, deflecting **80% of repetitive tickets** and cutting response time **65%**, while shipping production code in React, Node.js, and AWS Serverless.

Atlas Mental Health, Head of Engineering San Francisco · Nov 2019 - Nov 2020

- Led the founding engineering team for mobile, web, and cloud products serving 300,000+ students and counselors, owning architecture, hiring, and delivery from zero to launch.
- Shipped a HIPAA-compliant platform in under six months (encryption, audit logging, access controls) on React Native Web and Firebase, with event-driven patterns for reliability and cost control.

EARLIER ROLES

Sarment , VP of Engineering San Francisco ·	Jul 2018 - Oct 2019
PowWow Mobile , Developer Relations Engineer San Francisco ·	Jan 2017 - May 2018
OpenVPN , Sr Web Developer Pleasanton, CA ·	Jan 2015 - Jan 2017
ConnectionsSF by Club Quarters , General Manager, San Francisco ·	Jan 2012 - Nov 2014
Blade Runner Tools , Co-Founder and CTO San Francisco ·	Sep 2009 - Dec 2011
UCSF Medical Center , Sr Programmer/Analyst II San Francisco ·	Apr 2004 - Sep 2009

SKILLS

Leadership & Architecture: Engineering Leadership, Team Scaling (40+ Engineers), Hiring and Management Development, Budgeting, Roadmap Planning, Delivery Benchmarking, Launch Management, Full-Stack Architecture, Availability and Cycle-Time Optimization

Cloud & Stack: AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3, CloudFormation), Serverless, CI/CD, DevOps, Containerization, Event-Driven Systems, Microservices, Database Design, Datadog, React, TypeScript, Node.js, React Native, Python, Firebase, MongoDB, API Design

Domain Expertise: Healthcare (HIPAA), Fintech (PCI DSS), Payments, B2B SaaS, AI Workflows, Mobile and Web Platforms, Agile, Startup Execution

EDUCATION

San Francisco State University, BA, Philosophy major (pre-law), 2008